

Examples of FESP Committee Meeting Minutes for Developing and Improving Curriculum

October 7, 2016 FESP Committee Meeting Minutes

Time/Location: 4:00pm, ERF 1047

Attendance: Vahe Caliskan, Mustafa Mahamid, Saeed Manafzadeh, Alan Zdunek

1. Pre-Advising Week

- a. Break-out department sessions, contact your students on where session will be held.
- b. Departments will follow their specific procedures on pre-advising their students (MIE will advise the freshmen during their session); Pat Troy sent powerpoint presentation to use as a template for advising procedures
- c. Present "Engineering Tips" powerpoint slides from last year (soft skills, professionalism)
- d. Present FESP video from last year. Both presentations are in Box

2. Mini-project II planning

- a. Break-out project sessions start Week 12, Tuesday November 8th
- b. CME, ECE, MIE, CHE will be following similar projects from last year
- c. **We did not discuss the Due Date for the project; do we want to make it Tuesday November 22nd, or the following Tuesday, November 29th?**

3. ENGR100 Schedule on next page

- a. 3 more speakers planned, CME, ECE, IE

- **Next meeting – To be determined**

ENGR100 SCHEDULE

Week 1 Tuesday August 23rd	C. Kuypers Orientation
Week 2 Tuesday August 30th	C. Kuypers Resume writing
Week 3 Tuesday September 6th	C. Kuypers & FESP committee Introduce mini project #1, by group - 4:15pm
Week 4 Tuesday September 13th	Speaker – MIE
Week 5 Tuesday September 20th	Speaker- CHE
Week 6 Tuesday September 27th	Speaker - BIOE Mini Project #1 due - Friday
Week 7 Tuesday October 4th	Speaker- CS
Week 8 Tuesday October 11th	Speaker - CME
Week 9 Tuesday October 18th	In your major – Pre-advising Breakout - reserve rooms Introduce Mini Project #2 What is engineering? / professionalism
Week 10 Tuesday October 25th	Speaker - ECE
Week 11 Tues Nov 1	Speaker - IE
Week 12 Tues Nov 8	In your major – Mini Project #2
Week 13 Tues Nov 15	In your major – Mini Project #2
Week 14 Tues Nov 22	In your major - Mini Project #2
Week 15 Tues Nov 29	No class

May 1, 2017 FESP Meeting Minutes

FESP Meeting Items:

- 1) **FESP Committee recommendation for ENGR100 Fall Schedule** (per our last meeting)
 - a. WEEKS 1-5: College Orientation, Career Development, FESP Mini-project I (Chris Kuypers, Engineering Career Center, FESP committee, TA's)
 - b. WEEKS 6-8: Industry Speakers (Individual Speakers or Panel Discussions)
 - c. WEEK 9: Pre-Advising Break-out Session (by major)
 - d. WEEK 10-14: FESP Mini-project II (Hands-on project by major, FESP committee)

2) Implications of a larger freshmen class (600 students projected)

a. COE proposes splitting ENGR 100 (freshmen) into 2 sections –

- i. Tu 3:30-4:45 (3 majors)
- ii. Th 3:30-4:45 (3 majors) But what about Undecided Students?

How will two Freshmen Sections affect the FESP Tasks (Industry Speakers, Mini-projects I and II) and the FESP committee time commitment?

- 1) **Industry speakers:** Departments will be responsible for a speaker in their respective section. For example, Tuesday Section; BioE, ChE, CS, and Thursday Section; CME, ECE, MIE. FESP committee time commitment should be the same.
- 2) **Mini-project I:** FESP committee members will be responsible for the project in their respective section. Same time commitment.
- 3) **Mini-Project II:** Sessions will be much larger especially for the majors with large increases in enrollment. How will we be able to effectively carry out Mini-project II? Additional classroom space may be needed, and we might not be able to handle all students during the allotted ENGR100 section time. FESP committee time commitment will also be increased.

3) Transfer Student ENGR100 sections

- a. Will they be included in FESP/GPIP this Fall?

If so, there will be mini-project coordination issues, and time commitment issues for FESP committee

4) Future Revisions to ENGR100/FESP:

- a. Hire/appoint a professor to run the FESP-related tasks (speakers, technical projects), COE administrator (Chris Kuypers) runs College Orientation tasks.

Can one instructor handle all engineering major projects?

Is there still a role for the FESP committee in this scenario?

July 17th 2017 FESP Meeting

3) Fall 2017 ENGR100 Enrollment: (Chris Kuypers, Instructor, SES 250)

- a. Tuesday: 249 enrolled (250 max)
- b. Thursday: 184 enrolled (250 max)
- c. Total: 433

Discussion: Not sure if T/Th sections are split-up by specific majors/undecideds:

Actions: AZ will check with C. Kuypers/L. Nitsche on section makeup (since this could effect Industry Speaker schedule), other?

4) ENGR100 Fall Schedule and Planning

- a. WEEKS 1-5: College Orientation, Career Development, FESP Mini-project I (Chris Kuypers, Engineering Career Center, FESP committee, TA's)
- b. WEEKS 6-8: Industry Speakers (Individual Speakers or Panel Discussions)

Discussion: Do we need to revise based on item 1?

Each department responsible for one speaker? Utilize Chris Kuyper speaker contacts? Speakers that are more 'accessible' to students (ie, closer in age, recent alumni)

- c. WEEK 9: Pre-Advising Break-out Session (by major)
- d. WEEK 10-14: FESP Mini-project II (Hands-on project by major, FESP committee)

Discussion: Requires updated projects/logistics due to larger student enrollment?

Other discussion: FESP TA needed; Major-specific student tutors/TA's for ENGR100 and mini-projects

Action items:

5) Future Revisions to ENGR100/FESP:

- a. "On the table" from COE: Hire/appoint one faculty to run the FESP-related tasks (speakers, technical projects), Chris Kuypers runs College Orientation tasks.

- b. FESP recommends that if a professor is hired to run ENGR100/FESP, will still need (at least) one person from each major to coordinate project activities plus student help with project activities (ie, FESP team)

Discussion:

What can we propose as a long-term plan for ENGR100/FESP?

What parts of ENGR100/FESP do we keep, what parts do we change?

Action Items:

ENGR100/FESP IDEAS

1. Princeton University “Freshman Seminar Series”

The goals of the course are to establish a framework for understanding technology and its applications, to present fundamental principles of science and program management, and to motivate students to learn more about the many facets of engineering.

A basic philosophy of the course is that technical material must be presented in a context that is real and relevant to first-year students. At this early stage of their academic careers, measuring student performance is less of a concern than is introducing concepts that will reappear during the remainder of their stay in college. Thus, lectures and discussions are aimed at a high level, but students are not expected to respond beyond reasonable norms.

The seminar is one of 55 freshman seminars offered by the university, and it was the first to be taught by an engineering faculty member. The freshman seminars are designed to enrich the firstyear undergraduate experience by enabling students to work closely with a faculty member in small groups exploring significant ideas and documents. Enrollment is limited to 15 students chosen for their interest in participating in a rigorous, intellectual endeavor.

2. CDIO Approach to Engineering Education: Conceive, Design, Implement, Operate (MIT Initiative; <http://web.mit.edu/edtech/casestudies/cdio.html>)

The success of real-world engineering requires more than knowledge of engineering fundamentals; it requires abilities ranging from experience with hands-on design-build projects to skills in communications and teamwork. The task of educating engineers demands a new conceptual framework that teaches professional, personal, and interpersonal skills, in addition to the technical fundamentals.

Curricula is modified to include design-and-build projects. Conventional subjects were coordinated to demonstrate the interdisciplinary nature of engineering. Challenging experiences were created in which students design, build and operate product systems.

In addition to theoretical problem solving, classes now include team-based projects progressing in complexity toward an elective capstone design course that requires students to integrate and apply their cumulative knowledge to a comprehensive project.

3. Provide 'engineering problem solving' tasks using theory and concepts in prerequisite courses like Calculus/Differential Equations, Physics, Chemistry to reinforce why these courses are important to subsequent engineering courses. Incorporate team-building and communication skills in these tasks.

August 2nd FESP Meeting

- 1) Fall 2017 Enrollment (see spreadsheet)
- 2) FESP TA and Teaching aides:
 - a. FESP TA: Deisy Arrington, ChE PhD student
 - b. Additional teaching aides approved: each unit will hire the students and the college will reimburse at the end of the year.
 - c. Teaching Aide I @ \$9.50/hour

Job Comments: Hiring Teaching Aide I for the FESP program

 - d. Specific procedure to hire students: AZ to send email to FESP

3) ENGR100 Fall Schedule and Planning

Freshman ENGR100 is Tues/Thurs 3:30-4:45pm (2 sections)

Week 1: Introductions, Engineering Career Center

Week 2: Engineering Career Center; Resume Writing, prep for Career Fair

Week 3: Resumes Due, Engineering Career Center presentations

Week 4: Engineering Career Fair/ Chris Kuyper presentations

Week 5: Group Dynamics

Week 6: Mini-project I introduction. Students form teams in class, then start working on it for remainder of class;

Week 7: 2 panel discussions, One on Tuesday, One on Thursday. ~4 speakers each day. Speakers characteristics; preferably young engineers practicing in industry, UIC graduates if possible. Available for one or both discussion sections.

Week 8: Presentations by Student Engineering Societies; at least one from each major.

Week 9: Pre-advising week Break-out sessions.

Weeks 10-14: FESP Mini-project II

4) TESP (Transfer Engineering Success Program)

5) Action Items

6) Next Meeting

Minutes from the July 25th 2018 meeting:

Attendees: Saeed Manafzadeh, Mustafa Mahamid, Alan Zdunek

ACTION ITEMS

1. FESP team to hire undergraduate Teaching Aides.
2. FESP team to invite recent UIC grads for panel discussion Week 8 (Oct 16th and 18th), see description below.
3. Discussion on an activity for Week 7
4. Next FESP meeting: Week of August 13-17

Here is the tentative schedule for ENGR100 and the FESP portion (Weeks 6-14):

FESP /ENGR100 Schedule:

Freshman ENGR100 is Tues/Thurs 3:30-4:45pm (2 sections)

Week 1 to Week 5: No FESP activities

Week 6: FESP activities start: Mini-project I assigned, Due Friday October 26th.

Students form teams in class, then start working for remainder of class with help of TA's.

Discussed how to divide week 6-8 so each department could go just once a week (Tues or Thurs).

Discussed creating a template/cover page for report submission that would include names, table, etc., also a filename protocol for submission.

Week 7: OPEN, NEED TO DECIDE ON AN ACTIVITY (Last year were the Engineering Society presentations but that will be done during Weeks 1-5).

Week 8: Industry Panel Discussion

>40 minute panel discussion with engineers from industry. Invite Alumni/Recent grads <5 years. Each department should invite at least 2 persons; must cover Tuesday and Thursday sections. For the panel some questions could be provided to start or facilitate the discussion. Need a moderator.

Week 9 – Pre-advising break-out sessions by department.

Mini-project I will be due at the end of this week (Friday, October 26th)

Week 10-14: Mini-Project II: Due Friday November 30th

Problem solving and hands on project, FESP team shared their project II from last year and ideas for this year, including coding/computer activities.

Regards,

Alan

Minutes from the July 15th 2019 meeting:

Attendees: Vahe Caliskan, Miiri Kotche, Saeed Manafzadeh, Simona Narubin, Patrick Troy, Alan Zdunek

1. We decided to streamline undergraduate TA hiring, organization and duties
 - a. ENGR100 and FESP TA's will be the same, Simona will hire and TA's with guidance and recommendations from FESP committee and supervise during the Fall and Spring semester. Plan on 1 UG TA per 15-20 students.
 - b. UG TA's can apply for the position at: go.uic.edu/Apply4ENGR100TA
2. We decided not to have a FESP TA this year (graduate TA). Simona Narubin will take over any responsibilities that the FESP TA performed (grading, supervising UG TA's, etc).
3. Discussion of ENGR100 and FESP (breakout session) activities and assignments (see below)
4. FESP team needs to find a suitable classroom for their department hands-on project. Some ideas are: ROTC room in the Roosevelt Building, Thomas Beckham Hall rooms, Makerspace room.
5. FESP team to revise Mini-project I as Assignment 4 below and send assignment description and tasks to Simona.
6. Discussed future of ENGR100/FESP moving forward after Fall 2019. For instance, the GPIP requirements need to be changes since FESP is now incorporated into ENGR100. We decided to meet regularly during the semester to discuss in detail and make recommendations. We will meet 4 times or once a month (Sept-Dec). Possible meeting day/time: Wednesdays at 2pm.
7. Alan will request engineering student retention data from the OIR so that we can analyze the effectiveness of ENGR100 and FESP activities. Goal is to write an engineering education article on our findings.
8. Next ENGR100 meeting: Tentative July 31st, 1-2pm. SEO 227

ENGR100 Schedule:

Freshman ENGR100 is Tues 3:30-4:45pm and Thurs 2:00-3:15pm in Lecture Center A1

Not Freshmen ENGR100 is Tues 2:00- 3:15pm and Thurs 3:30-4:45pm in Lecture Center A1

Week 1 to Week 8 Activities:

1. Student organization presentations
2. Counseling Center
3. Women's Leadership
4. Gender and Sexuality
5. Consulting (Branden Irvin, Jensen & Hughes)
6. Engineering Career Center

Week 9 – Pre-advising break-out sessions by department.

Week 10-14: Assignment 4: Hands-On Project (Formerly Mini-Project II)

Assignment due November 29th

ENGR100 Assignments:

1. Lynda Skill tutorial/playlist
2. Visit student organizations
3. Individual Course planning and scheduling (Merged part of former Mini-project I with last year's ENGR100 assignment)
4. "Get to Know Your Department", Upper-class student interviews (Former Mini-project I)
5. Hands-on Project (Formerly Mini-project II)

Minutes from the November 20th 2019 meeting: 10-11am

Attendees: Saeed Manafzadeh, Hossein Atei, Alan Zdunek, Vahe Caliskan, Miiri Kotche, Simona Narubin

ENGR100: Creating ENGR101 for breakout sessions

ENGR101 will be used as the course number for the break-out sessions for both Freshmen and Not-freshmen sections starting next Fall 2020. This will allow creation of official course days/times and classrooms for the department specific breakout sessions and will be spread out from Monday-Friday. Coordination between departments and Course Scheduling will be needed. ENGR101 will follow the same curriculum as the existing Break-out sessions; Transfer students during Week 1-8 and Freshmen during Week 9-15. FESP committee will direct and oversee the technical aspects of ENGR100. Undergraduate TA's will be hired for both ENGR100 (mainly grading) and for ENGR101 to lead the breakout sessions. The undergraduate TA's will be trained on teaching and social belonging skills.

ENGR100/101 course schedule

- a. Freshmen sections:
 - i. ENGR100 Week 1-8 in Large lecture halls
 - ii. ENGR 101 Week 9-15 in Department specific classrooms
- b. Not-Freshmen sections:
 - i. ENGR100 Week 9-15 in Department specific classrooms
 - ii. ENGR 101 Week 1-8 in Large lecture halls.

Fall 19 Breakout Session Update

Discussed the different breakout sessions; CS/ECE combined sessions, BIOE collaboration with Makerspace. All breakout sessions went well.

Grading was discussed and we decided on the following guidelines:

1. Satisfactory grade: Attended breakout sessions (one unexcused absence), submitted report, participated in presentation (if applicable)
2. Unsatisfactory grade: Did not submit report or did not participate in presentation (if applicable) or did not show up to any sessions
3. Satisfactory grade for ENGR 100 but not eligible for GPIIP: Missed more than one breakout session.

ASEE Abstract and Paper

“Evolution of a Freshman Engineering Seminar”

Abstract accepted, paper is due February (?) 2020. FESP committee, Simona N. authors

Miiri and Simona will need help in writing the paper, Hossein, Alan, Vahe offered to help out.

Simona discussed adding information from the Office of Research on Student Success on student retention, social belonging. We can cite higher ed publications from their office and other collaborations. She is in contact with Eric Schwarze, Sue Farrugia and Charu(sp?) from that office.

NEXT Meeting:

Early January